is called the North Pole and the other pole is called the South Pole. Magnetic poles always exist in pairs.

What happens when a bar magnet is broken into two pieces? Each broken piece behaves like a separate bar magnet. When a magnet is split vertically, the length of the magnet is altered and each piece acts as a magnet. When a magnet is split horizontally, the length of the new pieces of magnet remains unaltered and there is no change in their polarity. In both cases the strength of the magnet is reduced.

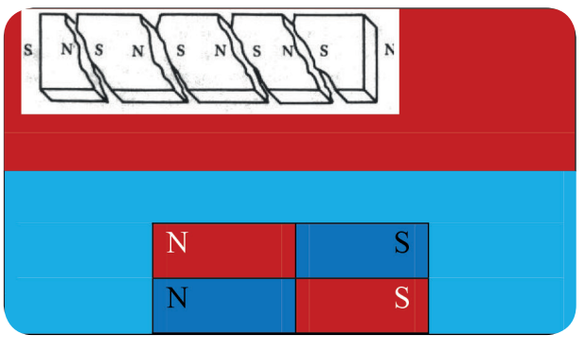
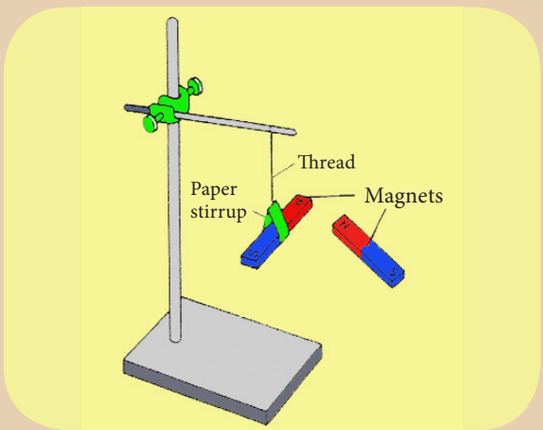


Figure 7.3 Magnetic poles exist in pair

7.2.2 Repulsive Property

Activity 2

Take a bar magnet and suspend it from a support. Hold another bar magnet in your hand. Bring the north pole of this magnet close to the north pole of the suspended magnet. What do you see? The north pole of the suspended magnet will move away.

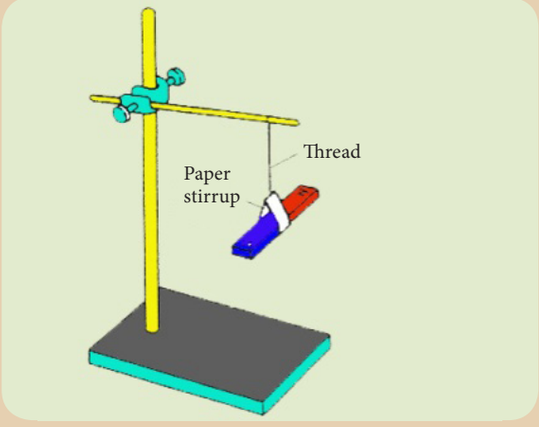


This activity explains another property of a magnet that like poles repel each other i.e., a north pole repels another north pole and a south pole repels another south pole. If you bring the south pole of the magnet close to the north pole of the suspended magnet you can see that the south pole of the suspended magnet is immediately attracted. Thus, we can conclude that unlike poles of a magnet attract each other. i.e., the north pole and the south pole of a magnet attract each other.

7.2.3 Directive Property

Activity 3

Suspend a bar magnet from a rigid support using a thread. Ensure that there are no magnetic substances placed near it. Gently disturb the suspended magnet. Wait for a moment, let it oscillate. In a short time it will come to rest. You can see that the north pole of the magnet is directed towards the geographic north. Repeat the procedure a number of times. You will observe that the magnet is oriented in the same direction.



This experiment shows that a freely suspended bar magnet always aligns itself in the geographic north-south direction. The property of a magnet, by which it aligns itself along the geographic north-south direction, when it is freely suspended, is known as the directive property of a magnet. The north pole of the

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